Updated September 2026

James M Bort
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ACADEMIC POSITIONS

DePaul University	Assistant Professor	2023 -
University of Missouri – Columbia	Assistant Professor	2020 - 2023
National University of Singapore	Visiting Scholar	2020
Syracuse University	Instructor	2018-2020

EDITORIAL POSITIONS

Entrepreneurship Theory and Practice	Action Editor	2026 –

EDUCATION

Syracuse University	PhD, Business Administration (Entrepreneurship) Advisor: Johan Wiklund
Syracuse University	Master of Business Administration
State University of New York Polytechnic	Bachelor of Science, Computer Science

INTERESTS

Research: Start-up workforce, firm growth, neurodiversity, job satisfaction, computational social science
Teaching: Innovation, entrepreneurial strategy start-up employment, the psychology of the entrepreneur, ethics in entrepreneurship, institutions

RESEARCH

Publications

Bort, J. & Wiklund, J. (2026) "A Conceptualization of the Cultic Startup". *Journal of Business Venturing Insights, Volume 25, 2026, e00616*

Bort, J. (2026) "The Promise and Perils of Co-Construction: A Reply To 'Co-Constructive Startup Illusions". *Academy of Management Review, 51, 2, 426-428*

Bort, J. (2026) "A Theory of the Start-up Workforce". *Academy of Management Review, 51, 2, 376-393*

Bort, J. & Wiklund, J., & Yu, W. (2025) "Firm Growth and the Job Satisfaction of the Startup Workforce." *Strategic Management Journal*, *46, 10, 2535-2572*

Bort, J., Moss, T., & Renko, M. (2024) "Legitimacy Spillovers and Hybrid Rhetoric in Crowdfunded Microloans." *International Small Business Journal, 42, 7, 841-862*

Bort, J., Meoli, A., & Sullivan, D. (2024) "Financing A Free-for-All: Crowdfunding Open-Source Software". *Small Business Economics, 63, 4, 1449-1469*

Yu, W., Fei, J., Peng, G., & **Bort, J.** (2024) "When a Crisis Hits: An Examination of the Impact of the Global Financial Crisis and the COVID-19 Pandemic on Financing for Female Entrepreneurs." *Journal of Business Venturing*, *39, 2, 106379*

Bort, J., Wiklund, J., Crawford, C., Lerner, D., & Hunt, R. (2024) "The Strategic Advantage of Impulsivity in Entrepreneurial Action: An Agent-Based Modeling Approach." *Entrepreneurship Theory and Practice, 48, 2, 547-580*

Bort, J., & Totterman, H. (2023) "The Growth Aspirations of Underdog Entrepreneurs." *Journal of Business Research, 165, 114055*

Meoli, A., Munari, F., & **Bort, J.** (2019) "The Patent Paradox in Crowdfunding: An empirical analysis of Kickstarter data." *Industrial and Corporate Change, 28(5), 1321-1341*

Editorial Work

Wiklund, J., Tran, H., Perez-Luño, A., **Bort, J.,** & Yu, W. (2026) "The Research Handbook of Neurodiversity and Entrepreneurship" *Edward Elgar Publishing, chapter collection in progress*

Bort, J., Wiklund., J., Engel, Y., Van Lancker, E., & Collewaert, V. "The Start-up Workforce" *special issue proposal accepted and in progress at Entrepreneurship Theory & Practice*

Under Review

Lee, S., Wiklund, J., & **Bort, J.** [Employees and Founder Well-being]. *Under Review at Entrepreneurship Theory and Practice*

Book Chapters and Published Conference Papers

Bort, J., Meoli, A. (2022). "Gender and Open Innovation Strategy in Crowdfunding." In Vorley, Smith, & Owalla (Eds). Gender, Diversity and Innovation: Concepts, policies and practice. *Edward Elgar.*

Bort, J., Yu, W., & Wiklund, J. (2021). "Growth." In Dana Paul, L. (Ed). World Encyclopedia of Entrepreneurship – 2nd volume. *Edward Elgar.*

Bort, J., Stephan, U., & Wiklund, J. (2021). "The Well-being of Entrepreneurs and their Stakeholders." In Cardon, Frese, & Gielnik (Eds). The Psychology of Entrepreneurship: New Perspectives – 2nd volume of The Psychology of Entrepreneurship. *Routledge*

Andrus, J., Sullivan, D., **Bort J.,** & Gupta, VK. (2021) "You May Not Notice, But It's Still There: Gender Bias in Crowdfunding Success" *Frontiers of Entrepreneurship Research BCERC Proceedings. 41*

Bort, J., Ward, MK., Wiklund, J., & Cummings, C. (2019) "Work Design and Employee Job Satisfaction in The Modern Entrepreneurial Workplace." *Frontiers of Entrepreneurship Research BCERC Proceedings. 39*

Moss, T., Renko, M., & **Bort, J**. (2019) "Exploring the Antecedents of Hybrid Claims: A Microfoundations Approach to Hybridity in Microenterprises." *The Academy of Management Best Paper Proceedings.*

Lerner, D., Crawford, C., **Bort, J.,** & Wiklund, J. (2017) "Speed vs Accuracy: Experimentally modeling the strategic utility of impulsivity in entrepreneurship." *Frontiers of Entrepreneurship Research BCERC Proceedings. 37*

Translational

Bort, J., Markowitz., M & Corey. J. (2026), "Underdog Entrepreneurs Need More Than Capital to Grow", *Entrepreneur & Innovation Exchange*

Bort, J., Hunt, R., & Wiklund, J. (2025), "Why Impulsive Founders Sometimes Win Big.", *Entrepreneur & Innovation Exchange*

Bort, J., Wiklund, J., & Yu, W. (2025), "Why Startup Success Can Become Employee Stress.", *Entrepreneur & Innovation Exchange*

Select Works in Progress

Bort, J. [Creating Video Games for Experiments]. (Collecting Data)

Bort, J., Yang, S., Carnevale., J. & Pidduck, R. [Measuring Start-up Employee Co-Construction]. (Collecting Data)

Bort, J. & Wiklund, J. [Employees of Cult-Like Start-ups]. (Preparing Draft)

Engle, Y., De Cuyper, L., & **Bort, J.** [Heterogeneity of Start-up Employers]. (Early Stage)

Conference Presentations

Lee, S., Bort, J., & Wiklund, J. "How working hours regulation influences entrepreneurs' subjective well-being" Annual Entrepreneurship Health & Well-being Conference, Syracuse, NY (October 2025)

Andrus, J., Sullivan, D., & Bort, J. “Gender Differences in Resource Allocation: The Impact of Shifting Standards and Benevolent Sexism” Academy of Management Conference, Chicago, IL (August 2024)

Bort, J. “Creating and Using Video Games for Entrepreneurship Research” Babson College Entrepreneurship Research Conference, Munich, Germany (June 2024)

Moss, T., Bort, J., Canova, J. “Walking the Talk: Examining Intrinsic Motivation In Prosocial Microlending” Babson College Entrepreneurship Research Conference, Munich, Germany (June 2024)

Li, X., Crawford, C., & Bort, J., “Investigating the Emergence of Outliers in The Context of Crowdfunding: A Power-Law Perspective” Babson College Entrepreneurship Research Conference, Boston, MA (June 2023)

Bort, J., Meoli, A., Sullivan, D., & Andrus, J. “Open Innovation, Open Wallets? Innovation Strategy Congruence in Crowdfunding” Academy of Management Conference, Seattle, WA (August 2022)

Bort, J., Wiklund, J., Ward, MK., & Tran, M. “Work Design in a Scale-Up Firm” USASBE, Raleigh, NC (January 2022)

Andrus, J., Sullivan, D., Bort, J., & Gupta, VK. "The Shadow Pandemic: COVID-19 and Vertical Gender Bias Against Female-Led Crowdfunding Ventures" Academy of Management Conference, *virtual* (August 2021)

Andrus, J., Sullivan, D., Bort, J., & Gupta, VK. "You May Not Notice, But It’s Still There: Gender Bias in Crowdfunding Success", Babson College Entrepreneurship Research Conference, *virtual* (June 2021)

Bort J., Gish, J., & Wiklund, J. "Organizational Virtue Signaling & Behavior Congruence: The Employee Perspective" Babson College Entrepreneurship Research Conference, *canceled* (June 2020)

Moss, T., Renko, M., Bort, J. “Exploring the antecedents of hybrid claims: A micro-foundations approach to hybridity in microenterprises”. Academy of Management Conference, Boston, MA (August 2019)*

Bort, J., & Moss, T., J. Wiklund, J., “Aspirations over ambitions? The impact of aspirational orientation on performance in prosocial crowdfunding.” Babson College Entrepreneurship Research Conference, Boston, MA (June 2019)

Bort, J., Cummings, C., Wiklund, J., & Ward, MK. “Work design and job satisfaction in the modern entrepreneurial workplace” Babson College Entrepreneurship Research Conference, Boston, MA (June 2019)*

Bort, J., & Moss, T. "Walking the Talk: Examining intrinsic motivation in prosocial microlending." Sustainability, Entrepreneurship, & Ethics Conference, Miami, FL (March 2019)

Moss, T., Renko., M., Bort, J. "Exploring the antecedents of hybrid claims: A micro-foundations approach to hybridity in microenterprises". 15th Annual Social Entrepreneurship Conference, Los Angeles, CA (November 2018)

Lerner, D., Crawford, C., Bort, J., & Wiklund, J. "Moving (Impulsively) Forward: Speed Versus Accuracy in the Emergence of New Organizations". Academy of Management Conference, Chicago, IL (August 2018)

Bort, J., & Moss, T. "Walking the Talk: Examining intrinsic motivation in prosocial microlending." 14th Annual Social Entrepreneurship Conference, Boston, MA (November 2017)

Meoli, A., Munari, F., & Bort, J. "The Patent Paradox in Crowdfunding: An empirical analysis of Kickstarter data". Academy of Management Conference, Atlanta, GA (August 2017)

Lerner, D., Crawford, C., Bort, J., & Wiklund, J. "Speed vs Accuracy: Experimentally modeling the strategic utility of impulsivity in entrepreneurship." Babson College Entrepreneurship Research Conference, Norman, OK (June 2017)*

Bort, J. & Wiklund, J. "Growing firms, happy employees? The influence of new venture growth on employee well-being.", Babson College Entrepreneurship Research Conference, Norman, OK (June 2017)

Symposia, Workshops, & Consortia

20th Anniversary of the Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal Conference, ": Value Created or Value Transferred? What Should We Be Measuring? (*panelist)*, Austin, TX (September, 2026)

Academy of Management Conference, HR in Motion: People and Practices in SMEs, Entrepreneurial, and Growing Firms, (*presenter*), Philadelphia, PA (July 2026)

DePaul University Liberal Arts & Social Sciences Student/Alumni Career Night and Social; Creating Your Own Career Path: Advice from Alumni Entrepreneurs (*moderator)*, Chicago, IL (April, 2026)

Annual Entrepreneurship Health & Well-being Conference, (*panelist),* Syracuse, NY (October 2025)

Academy of Management Conference, Health, Wellbeing and Entrepreneurship *(presenter)*, Copenhagen, Denmark (July 2025)

New Perspectives on Entrepreneurial Diversity and Well-being: Implications for Theory and Practice (*presenter*), Dublin, Ireland (June 2024)

Academy of Management Conference, Fusing disparate Research Streams: Mental Health, Well-being, and Entrepreneurship (*presenter),* Seattle, WA (August 2022)

Scale-ups, Scaling, and Scalability Paper Development Workshop hosted by Journal of Business Venturing (*participant)*, Virtual. (September 2021)

2020 Global B Academics Paper Development Workshop (*presenter*), Virtual Workshop (August 2020)

Academy of Management Conference, Neurodiversity and the Future of Work in Entrepreneurial and Organizational Contexts (*presenter)*, canceled (August 2020)

Academy of Management Entrepreneurship Division Doctoral Consortium (*participant*), Boston, MA (August 2019)

The Future of Conducting and Publishing Research in Entrepreneurship, Innovation Management and Strategy (*participant*), Bologna, Italy (May 2019)

Sustainability, Entrepreneurship, & Ethics Doctoral Consortium (*participant*), Miami, FL (March 2019)

USASBE Doctoral Consortium (*participant*), St. Petersburg, FL (January 2019)

Academy of Management Conference, "Outliers in Entrepreneurship" PDW (*presenter*), Chicago, IL (August 2018)

Babson Doctoral Consortium, (*participant*), Waterford, Ireland (June 2018)

Academy of Management Conference, Symposium on Entrepreneurship and Wellbeing (*presenter*), Atlanta, GA (August 2017)

Invited Seminars

University of Central Florida, Orlando, FL (Spring, 2027)

DePaul University Doctoral Business Administration Alumni Day, Chicago, IL (Sept, 2026)

Beta Hub, DePaul University, Chicago IL (March 2025)

Aalto University, Espoo, Finland (November 2024)

Dissertation Committees

Shanon Yang, Syracuse University, expected graduation 2028 (*member*)

TEACHING

DePaul University	MBA Capstone	Autumn, 2026	
DePaul University	Business Plan Development	Autumn, 2026	
DePaul University	Business Plan Development	Spring, 2026	(4.2/5)
DePaul University	New Venture Management (Grad)	Autumn, 2025	(4.6/5)
DePaul University	Business Plan Development	Autumn, 2025	(4.5/5)
DePaul University	Business Innovation & Design (2 sections)	Winter, 2024	(4.5/5)
DePaul University	Business Plan Development	Autumn, 2024	(4.6/5)
DePaul University	Business Innovation & Design (Grad)	Autumn, 2024	(4.9/5)
DePaul University	Business Innovation & Design (Grad)	Spring, 2024	(4.7/5)
DePaul University	Business Innovation & Design (2 sections)	Winter, 2024	(4.2/5)
DePaul University	Business Innovation & Design (Grad)	Autumn, 2023	(4.6/5)
DePaul University	Management of Tech & Innovation (Grad/UGrad)	Autumn, 2023	(4.5/5)
University of Missouri	Principals of Entrepreneurship	Spring, 2023	(4.9/5)
University of Missouri	Principals of Entrepreneurship (online)	Fall, 2022	(4.8/5)
University of Missouri	Principals of Entrepreneurship	Fall, 2022	(4.9/5)
University of Missouri	Innovation & Entrepreneurship (5G Tech)	Fall, 2021	(4.7/5)
University of Missouri	Principals of Entrepreneurship (online)	Fall, 2021	(4.5/5)
University of Missouri	Principals of Entrepreneurship	Fall, 2021	(4.9/5)
University of Missouri	Principals of Entrepreneurship	Spring, 2021	(4.8/5)
University of Missouri	Principals of Entrepreneurship (2 sections)	Fall, 2020	(4.5/5)
Syracuse University	Introduction to Entrepreneurship	Fall, 2019	(4.6/5)
Syracuse University	Introduction to Entrepreneurship	Fall, 2018	(4.4/5)

Professional Development & Certifications

Community-Based Service Learning, DePaul University Steans Center (July, 2025)
Teaching & Learning with Generative Artificial Intelligence, DePaul University Center for Teaching and Learning (December, 2025)

GRANTS

Current

Panel Study on Underdog Entrepreneurial Resilience and Well-being ($330,000), Co-PI, *AON Corporation,* 2025-2027

In Development

Understanding the Non-Linear Career Paths of the Start-up Workforce Through Work Design, and Well-being, Sole PI, *Preparing Submission*

Creating Video Games for Entrepreneurial Experiments, Sole PI, *Preparing Submission*

Completed

Open-Source Crowdfunding Projects ($1,124), *Trulaske Small Grant Fund*, 2021

AWARDS

Driehaus College of Business Research Paper of the Year Award, 2026
Dr. Torpey Teaching Award, Whitman School of Management ($1,250), 2019
Syracuse University Outstanding Teaching/Research Assistant, 2019
Whitman School of Management Summer Research Grant ($5,000), 2019
Graduate Student Organization Travel Grant ($250), 2019
Best Paper, 15th Annual Social Entrepreneurship Conference ($5,000), 2018
Whitman School of Management Summer Research Grant ($5,000), 2018
Graduate Student Organization Travel Grant ($180), 2018
Whitman School of Management Summer Research Grant ($4,000), 2017
Graduate Student Organization Travel Grant ($400), 2016

TRANSLATIONAL / PRACTICE

Disability Culture: ADHD & Entrepreneurship (*panelist*). University of Missouri (September 2021)

I-CAN: Innovation, College and Neurodiversity (*panelist*). Virtual (December 2020)

PODCASTS

July 2, 2026. Research Insights, "A Theory of the Start-up Workforce" ***Business Talk with Deepak Bhatt***

MEDIA / FEATURES COVERAGE

April 22, 2026. "Founders and Employees as Co-Constructors" ***Academy of Management Insights***
https://journals.aom.org/doi/epub/10.5465/amr.2023.0174.summary

March 25, 2026. "Opinion: Bold partnerships will power Chicago in a post-globalized world" ***Crains Chicago Business***
https://www.chicagobusiness.com/opinion/commentary/ccb-bold-partnerships-post-globalization-20260323/

November 5, 2025. "DePaul University partners with Aon and NFP on study supporting underserved small businesses" ***American Catholic Tribune***
https://americancatholictribune.com/stories/676079054-depaul-university-partners-with-aon-and-nfp-on-study-supporting-underserved-small-businesses

December 13, 2024. "CTA partners with DePaul University to improve support for small businesses, under-served Chicago neighborhoods" ***Mass Transit***
https://www.masstransitmag.com/management/press-release/55249623/chicago-transit-authority-cta-cta-partners-with-depaul-university-to-improve-support-for-small-businesses-under-served-chicago-neighborhoods

June 14, 2021. "Looking to add talent to your startup? First, define your key roles." ***Startup Missouri***. https://startup-mo.com/startups-define-key-roles-prior-seeking-talent/

SERVICE

Profession

Editorial Review Board

- Journal of Business Venturing (2023 – present)
- Journal of Business Research, Entrepreneurship Section (2025 – present)
- Entrepreneurship Theory & Practice (2020 - 2026)

Conference reviewer

- Babson College Entrepreneurship Research Conference
- Academy of Management Annual Conference (ENT Division)

Ad-hoc reviewer

- Small Business Economics
- Applied Psychology: An International Review
- Asian Pacific Journal of Management
- Academy of Management Review
- Journal of Business Ethics
- International Journal of Entrepreneurship Behavior & Research
- Business Research Quarterly
- Entrepreneurship Research Journal
- Venture Capital
- Journal of Management Studies
- Journal of Small Business Management
- Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal
- Journal of Simulation
- International Small Business Journal
- Business Strategy and the Environment
- Business & Society
- African Journal of Management
- Entrepreneurship & Regional Development
- British Journal of Management
- Journal of Management
- International Journal of Human Resource Management

University

DePaul University

Committee:

- Driehaus College of Business Faculty Research Release Policy Task Force, 2026-2027 (*member)*
- University Teaching Learning and Technology Committee, 2025-present (*member*)
- Research Committee, Management & Entrepreneurship Department, 2024 – present (*chair)*
- Assurance of Learning / Assessments Committee, Driehaus College of Business, 2024-2026 (*member*)
- Coleman Chair of Entrepreneurship Search Committee, 2024 (*member*)

- Research Committee, Management & Entrepreneurship Department, 2023 – 2024 (*member)*

Volunteer:

- LAS Student / Alumni Night, "Creating Your Own Career Path" (*panel moderator)*
- DePaul MBA Association Case Competition (*guest judge*)
- DePaul Annual Innovation Day, 2025 (*table moderator*)
- DePaul Collegiate Entrepreneurship Organization, 2024 (*guest judge)*
- Coleman Entrepreneurship Center Advisory Board, 2023 - present (*member*)

University of Missouri

- Trulaske International Week, Spring 2022 (*presenter)*
- Research Lightening Round, Management Advisory Board, Fall 2021 (*presenter*)
- Undergraduate Research Workshop, Fall 2021 (*panelist*)
- Trulaske Entrepreneurship Sub-Committee, 2020 – 2023 (*member)*

Syracuse University

- Guest Judge, Whitman School of Management Business Plan Capstone Competition, 2016-19
- Graduate Student Organization Senator, 2016-2018
- Graduate Student Academic Affairs Committee (*co-Chair*), 2017-2018
- University Senator, 2016
- Graduate Student Employment Issues Committee (*chair*), 2016

Community

- Guest Judge, Missouri DECA State Career Development Conference (Innovation Plan)

SELECT NON-ACADEMIC EXPERIENCE

Information Technology Manager, Syracuse University, Syracuse NY
Founder, bettyElm Records, Syracuse NY
Software Engineer, Partners in Health Systems, Syracuse NY [*early-stage employee*]